

Project Development

Implement Client Script & UI Policy (Incident) — ServiceNow

1. Overview

Incident records need consistent, accurate data for effective triage, routing, and resolution. Relying only on manual checks can lead to incomplete or incorrect data, which hurts reporting accuracy and SLA compliance. This project enforces conditional field behavior and validation at the UI level using ServiceNow UI Policies and Client Scripts, so Incident records meet business rules before they are submitted.

2. Objective

Demonstrate how client-side controls (UI Policies and Client Scripts) can dynamically make fields mandatory, auto-populate values, control field behavior, and block submission when required conditions aren't met — improving data quality and consistency on the Incident table.

3. Skills Used

- Incident Management
- UI Policy & UI Policy Actions
- Client Scripts (onChange, onSubmit, onCellEdit)
- Form Validation

4. Implementation Summary

Task 1 – UI Policy: High Impact Control

Created a UI Policy named "High Impact Control" on the Incident table, triggered when Impact = 1 - High. "Reverse if false" is enabled, so field changes revert automatically when the condition is no longer true.

The screenshot shows the ServiceNow UI Policy configuration interface. The left sidebar displays the navigation menu with 'UI Policies' selected under 'System UI'. The main content area shows the configuration for the 'High Impact Control' UI Policy on the 'Incident [Incident]' table. Key configuration details include:

- Table:** Incident [Incident]
- Application:** Global
- Active:** ☒
- Short description:** High Impact Control
- Order:** 100
- When to Apply:** Script
- Conditions:** Impact is 1 - High
- Global:** ☒
- Reverse if false:** ☒
- On load:** ☒
- Inherit:** ☐

UI Policy condition: Impact is 1 - High, with Reverse if false enabled

Task 2 – UI Policy Actions: Assignment Group & Urgency

Two UI Policy Actions were added to the policy: Assignment Group is made mandatory, and Urgency is made read-only, whenever the condition (Impact = High) is met.

The screenshot shows the ServiceNow UI Policy Action configuration page for 'assignment_group'. The left sidebar displays the navigation menu with 'UI Policies' expanded. The main content area shows the configuration for the 'High Impact Control' policy. The 'Table' is set to 'Incident [incident]'. The 'Field name' is 'Assignment group'. The 'Application' is 'Global'. The 'Mandatory' checkbox is checked (True). The 'Visible' dropdown is set to 'Leave alone'. The 'Read only' checkbox is checked (False). The 'Clear the field value' checkbox is unchecked. The 'Update' and 'Delete' buttons are visible at the bottom.

UI Policy Action — Assignment group set to Mandatory: True

The screenshot shows the ServiceNow UI Policy Action configuration page for 'urgency'. The left sidebar displays the navigation menu with 'UI Policies' expanded. The main content area shows the configuration for the 'High Impact Control' policy. The 'Table' is set to 'Incident [incident]'. The 'Field name' is 'Urgency'. The 'Application' is 'Global'. The 'Mandatory' dropdown is set to 'Leave alone'. The 'Visible' dropdown is set to 'Leave alone'. The 'Read only' checkbox is checked (True). The 'Clear the field value' checkbox is unchecked. The 'Update' and 'Delete' buttons are visible at the bottom.

UI Policy Action — Urgency set to Read only: True

Task 3 – onChange Client Script: Auto-set Urgency

An onChange script on the Impact field automatically sets Urgency to High when Impact is set to High, and shows an informational message to the user.

The screenshot shows the ServiceNow Client Script configuration interface. The script is named "Auto set urgency for high impact" and is associated with the "Incident" table. The UI Type is "Desktop", the Type is "onChange", and the Field name is "Impact". The script is set to "Isolate script" and is "Active". The script code is as follows:

```

1 function onChange(control, oldValue, newValue, isLoading) {
2   if (isLoading || newValue == '') {
3     return;
4   }
5   if (newValue == '1') { // High Impact
6     g_form.setValue('urgency', '1');
7     g_form.showFieldMsg(
8       'Impact',
9       'High Impact Incidents must have High urgency and an assignment group.',
10      'info'
11    );
12   }
13 }
14
15

```

onChange script auto-setting Urgency for High impact incidents

Task 4 – onSubmit Client Script: Save Validation

An onSubmit script blocks the save when Impact is High and Assigned To is empty, showing an inline error on the field.

The screenshot shows the ServiceNow Client Script configuration interface. The script is named "Prevent save if assigned to missing" and is associated with the "Incident" table. The UI Type is "Desktop", the Type is "onSubmit", and the Field name is "Impact". The script is set to "Isolate script" and is "Active". The script code is as follows:

```

1 function onSubmit() {
2   if (g_form.getValue('Impact') == '1' &&
3       g_form.getValue('assigned_to') == '') {
4     g_form.showErrorBox(
5       'assigned_to',
6       'Assigned To is mandatory for High impact incidents.'
7     );
8     return false;
9   }
10   return true;
11 }
12
13
14

```

onSubmit script requiring Assigned To for High impact incidents

Task 5 – onCellEdit Client Script: Protect State in List View

An onCellEdit script blocks inline edits to the State field from the Incident list view, prompting the user to open the record instead.

The screenshot shows the ServiceNow interface for configuring a Client Script. The script is named "Prevent state change via list edit" and is associated with the "Incident" table. The UI Type is set to "Desktop" and the Type is "onCellEdit". The Field name is "State". The script is active and global. The script code is as follows:

```

1 function onCellEdit(sysIDs, table, oldValues, newValue, callback) {
2
3     alert('State cannot be changed from the list. Please open the Incident.');
```

```

4
5     // Cancel the list edit
6     callback(false, oldValues);
7 }
8
9

```

The "Isolate script" checkbox is checked.

onCellEdit script preventing State changes from list editing

5. Testing & Results

Mandatory field enforcement

Setting Impact to High with Assigned To empty blocks the save and shows an error.

The screenshot shows the ServiceNow Incident form for "INC0010012". The form is in "New record" mode. The "Impact" field is set to "1 - High". The "Assigned to" field is empty. A red box highlights the "Assigned to" field with the error message: "Assigned To is mandatory for High impact incidents." The "Submit" button is disabled. The "Short description" is "testing UI policy".

Save blocked: "Assigned To is mandatory for High impact incidents."

Successful save

Once Assigned To is filled in, the record saves successfully; Urgency remains read-only as configured.

The screenshot shows the ServiceNow Incident form for INC0010012. The form is titled "Incident - Create INC0010012". The left sidebar shows the navigation menu with "Incident" selected. The main form area contains the following fields:

- Number: INC0010012
- Channel: -- None --
- * Caller: Adela Cervantsz
- State: New
- Category: Inquiry / Help
- Impact: 1 - High
- Subcategory: -- None --
- Urgency: 1 - High
- Service:
- Priority: 1 - Critical
- Service offering:
- * Assignment group: Software
- Configuration item:
- Assigned to: Beth Anglin (highlighted with a red box)
- * Short description: testing UI policy
- Description:

Below the form, there is a "Related Search Results" section with a search bar containing "testing UI policy" and a dropdown menu for "Knowledge & Catalog (AI)".

Incident saved successfully with Assigned To completed

Reverse condition

Changing Impact back to Medium reverses the policy effects — Assigned To is no longer mandatory and Urgency becomes editable again.

The screenshot shows the ServiceNow Incident form for INC0010012. The form is titled "Incident - INC0010012". The left sidebar shows the navigation menu with "Incident" selected. The main form area contains the following fields:

- Number: INC0010012
- Channel: -- None --
- * Caller: Adela Cervantsz
- State: New
- Category: Inquiry / Help
- Impact: 2 - Medium (highlighted with a red box)
- Urgency: 1 - High (highlighted with a red box)
- Subcategory: -- None --
- Service:
- Priority: 2 - High
- Service offering:
- Assignment group: Software
- Configuration item:
- Assigned to: (highlighted with a red box)
- * Short description: testing UI policy
- Description:

Below the form, there is a "Related Search Results" section with a search bar and a dropdown menu for "Knowledge & Catalog (AI)".

Impact changed to Medium — Urgency editable, Assigned To no longer required

List edit blocking

Attempting to edit the State field directly from the Incident list triggers a warning and the change is blocked.

The screenshot shows the ServiceNow interface for the 'Incidents' list. A modal alert is displayed in the center, stating: "dev354432.service-now.com says State cannot be changed from the list. Please open the Incident." with an 'OK' button. In the background, the 'Incidents' table is visible. The row for incident INC0008111 is highlighted, showing its state as 'In Progress'. The 'In Progress' dropdown menu is open, and the 'Save (Enter)' button is visible. The table columns include 'Number', 'Opened', 'Category', 'Assignment group', 'Assigned to', 'Updated', and 'Updated by'.

Number	Opened	Category	Assignment group	Assigned to	Updated	Updated by
INC0010012	2026-01-14 02:15:14	Inquiry / Help	Software	(empty)	2026-01-14 03:19:11	admin
INC0009009	2018-08-30 01:06:16	Inquiry / Help	(empty)	(empty)	2018-12-12 23:30:24	admin
INC0009005	2018-08-31 21:35:21	Software	(empty)	(empty)	2018-12-12 23:18:55	admin
INC0009001	2018-09-11 20:56:26	Inquiry / Help	(empty)	(empty)	2018-12-12 23:32:42	admin
INC0008112	2019-07-29 11:48:43	New	(empty)	(empty)	2019-07-29 11:49:28	admin
INC0008111	2019-07-22 14:04:57	New	(empty)	(empty)	2019-07-22 14:05:48	admin
INC0008001	2021-01-15 13:04:14	New	(empty)	(empty)	2021-01-21 15:31:42	admin
INC0007002	2018-10-16 22:47:51	New	(empty)	(empty)	2018-12-12 23:28:49	admin
INC0007001	2018-10-16 22:47:10	Hardware	Opspace	(empty)	2025-12-03 18:11:31	system
INC0001990	2020-06-07 09:02:25	Inquiry / Help	(empty)	(empty)	2020-06-07 09:04:34	admin
INC0000000	2016-08-10	Inquiry / Help	(empty)	(empty)	2016-08-10	admin

Alert: "State cannot be changed from the list. Please open the Incident."

6. Conclusion

This project shows how UI Policies and Client Scripts work together to enforce dynamic field behavior, automate updates, and prevent incorrect data submission on Incident forms. Using `onChange`, `onSubmit`, and `onCellEdit` scripts alongside UI Policy actions keeps fields like Assigned To and Urgency consistent with changes in Impact — a lightweight, practical approach to improving data integrity in ServiceNow.